

film festival

Cinematic Revelry

DELHI The much-awaited 10th edition of the Osian's Cinefan, a festival of Asian and Arab cinemas, opens at the Capital's Siri Fort Complex on July 10, giving cinema lovers a spectacular treat of 190 films from over 40 countries. The world's first and largest film festival devoted to the Asian and Arab cinemas is committed to bringing the finest films to the audience and reinventing a thoughtful film culture for our times. It opens with *Sparrow*, a movie by Hong Kong's renowned director Johnny To, which revolves around three professional pick-pockets and a young woman in search of an elusive key. Pascale Ferran's *Lady Chatterley*, based on D.H. Lawrence's classic, will also be showcased here. The movie has an understated eroticism and an elegant evocation of physical and spiritual love.

This year, the main focus of the festival is on international cinematic

works based on literary epics. So, you have *Fool's Alley* by Taufik Saleh (Egypt), *The Choice* by Youssef Chahine (Egypt) and *Midaq Alley* by George Fons (Mexico)—all of them have been adapted from the works of Nobel laureate Naguib Mahfouz.

There will be a special focus on *The Kiss of the Spider Woman*, a film based on Manuel Puig's novel. The festival has been divided into two main sections—competition and non-competition. While the first section includes four segments—Asian and Arab Cinema, India Cinema, First Features and Intolerance—the second section has segments like the Asian Frescoes, Indian Mosaic, Springboard, A New Focus, Films from Israel and Writing on Cinema.

This year's Israel-Palestinian section includes the Oscar nominated anti-war drama *Beaufort* (Hebrew) by Joseph Cedar. From the Indian curry, there is *Mukhbir* starring Om Puri and *Mohan Das* directed by Mazhar Kamran. On till July 20.

by Sheekesh Mishra

PICTURE PERFECT: A still from *Blood Brothers*, a Taiwanese film to be screened at the festival



art exhibition

A Refreshing Portrait

MUMBAI Even as the art scene is booming in Hyderabad with the opening of more galleries, there has been a concerted endeavour to exhibit the works of many young artists in other cities as well. Also, an art gallery, which had displayed the works of a number of established artists including the legendary T. Vaikuntam in Mumbai about six months ago, is now planning a reverse flow to introduce artists from other cities to collectors and art buffs in Hyderabad. It is now promoting works of a fresh crop of young painters. While B. Srinivasa Reddy is already a known name for his oil on canvas paintings, the others are debutants of sorts who have worked with mixed media on canvas and water colours on paper. Their portrayal is a refreshingly different sweep, covering life and its foibles with a few blurring into the abstract. Some of the artists whose work will be on display include Shrikant Kolhe, Kappari Kishan, Yasala Balaiah and Vedanti Kolhe. From June 19. At Studio Napean in Mumbai.

by Amarnath K. Menon

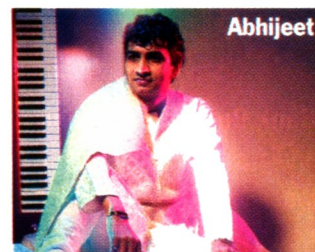
DIFFERENT SWEEP: A painting by Yasala Balaiah (right) and Kappari Kishan



music

Monsoon Harmony

MUMBAI In Hindustani classical tradition, the monsoon has always inspired musicians to create ragas. The Raga Malhar is one such creation, its various shades are one of the most precious inspirational creations by Tansen. In a jugalbandi, organised by the Banyan Tree, vocalist



Pandit Ajay Pohankar and his son Abhijeet on keyboard will recreate the magic of monsoon, followed by a performance by flute maestro Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia. At Nehru Centre. On July 11.